



Language Justice and Machine Translation on Social Media

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ABSTRACT

Machine translation (MT), which involves the use of algorithms to translate between languages, has advanced to a high level of quality for dozens of language pairs and is employed in an array of everyday contexts, including on social media. However, there are hundreds of languages for which there are insufficient digital resources to sustain quality machine translation, and errors abound even in translations for so-called “high-resource” language pairs. Meanwhile, although decades of research have led to improvements in MT system performance, recent scholarship has drawn attention to the social impact of MT systems. The present article builds on this burgeoning tradition and advocates for a *language justice* orientation in MT system development and design, focusing on online social media as a case study. This view advocates for transparency and consent in the application of machine translation. We also consider how language justice can inform the management of linguistic resources used to train MT systems.

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The possibility of language translation by machines has long captivated the imagination. Exponential increases in computational capacity, along with innovative uses of growing quantities of digital data, have ushered this vision closer to reality in the past half century. Contemporary machine translation (MT) technology boasts the capacity to translate between hundreds of language pairs (Costa-jussà et al. 7), and in spite of serious quality issues found in the datasets often used to train these models (Kreutzer et al. 23), MT system outputs have received scores from human judges¹ that are competitive with translations written by people (Akhbardeh et al. 15). In light of these vast technological improvements in recent years, it is more likely than ever that an individual will encounter content that has been translated by an algorithm in their day-to-day life – possibly unbeknown to the reader (or the original author).

Machine-translation systems are regularly consulted in high-stakes scenarios ranging from medical appointments to encounters with law enforcement (Liebling, Lahav et al.; Mehandru et al.). Browser plug-ins, mobile applications and social media platforms offer real-time translation of text or speech, usually relying on interfaces to proprietary or opaque algorithms. In this article we primarily consider the impact of machine translation in the digital realm, focusing on social media.

Translation between languages has long been characterized by political forces, shaped by histories of conflict and colonialism. The mere decision about which languages to target for the development of early MT technology was shaped by geopolitical conflict, as in the case of MT development focused on Russian–English translation commissioned by the US military during the Cold War to facilitate surveillance of Soviet scientific publications (Oettinger 75). Machine-translation tools further complicate fraught geopolitical dynamics as they are woven into discriminating systems such as the surveillance apparatus at the US border (Paullada).

However, discourse around machine translation is often utopian, animated by its imagined potential to promote cross-cultural understanding instantly and at scale. In a paper published in the proceedings of the International Conference on Machine Learning in 2012, as part of a call to action for the machine-learning community to do research that “matters”, researcher Kiri Wagstaff posed a challenge to build an MT system that could thwart a geopolitical conflict (4). While it is difficult to evaluate the counterfactual in this hypothetical scenario, it nonetheless illustrates a fascination with the possibility for translation to help humanity overcome cultural and linguistic barriers, and a utopian vision for machines to facilitate this connection and understanding.

Indeed, much rhetoric on the development of machine translation is focused on its purported ability to “break barriers”, and more recently, digital media giants have extended this metaphor by framing investment in machine translation as part of diversity and inclusion efforts. A recent blog post from Google, announcing the addition of 24 languages to its Translate product, begins: “For years, Google Translate has helped break down language barriers and connect communities all over the world”, with a tag on the post cataloguing this growth as part of “diversity and inclusion” (Caswell). In a similar vein, the video-sharing platform TikTok calls its in-app translation an investment towards making its “diverse community feel included” (Malik). As communication scholar Isabelle Zaugg points out, discourse about so-called “low-resource” languages, or those languages with relatively fewer digital resources or a smaller online presence, often uncritically emphasizes the importance of linguistic inclusion in the digital sphere (“Digital Surveillance” 1). Certainly, broadening access to online engagement is an admirable goal. However, this so-called inclusion might also make communities more vulnerable to digital surveillance (Zaugg, “Digital Surveillance” 2).

It has thus become essential to develop an understanding of machine translation as a sociotechnical system, comprised not only of the hardware and software that constitute the technical components of the system, but also the social contexts into which such systems are introduced and which are reshaped by this integration (Santy et al. 157). A sociotechnical analysis of machine translation draws attention to the actual situations of its use, the needs and practices of human users, and the power dynamics inherent to these interactions. If not

1 Typically, the human judges in these evaluations are crowdworkers who are not professional translators. For discussion on the ethical issues in this practice, see O’Hagan, “Ethics”.

carefully considered, MT technology may exacerbate social and economic inequalities ([Vieira et al. 1525](#); [Weber and Mehandru 110](#)).

In this article, we envision a *language justice* orientation towards MT system development and design that values transparency and consent over mere inclusion and access, drawing specific attention to the sociotechnical aspects of these systems. We illustrate this vision using social media as a case study. We begin by introducing the concept of language justice and describing the status quo of machine translation on social media. Next, we discuss particular considerations for shifting towards a language justice lens on machine translation on social media. Finally, we propose adaptations to the design of MT systems and language resource management strategies that support this shift.

LANGUAGE JUSTICE

In community organizing, *language justice* is realized through a set of practices that promote full and equal participation in multilingual spaces with an awareness of the social and political dimensions of language ([Arguelles et al.](#); [Cardinal et al.](#)). Extending these values to the digital sphere, Zaugg proposes three key elements of language justice in the digital sphere: “equitable access to digital tools in one’s primary language”, “digital support for all scripts” and “justice for speakers who may face harmful digital surveillance or under-moderation of language content”, while emphasizing that these steps should be taken following the leadership of the linguistic communities whose language is at stake ([“Language Justice” 246](#)).

Recent scholarship has drawn attention to ethical issues in digital translation, including the sourcing of evaluation data for MT systems ([O’Hagan, “Ethics”](#)). The ability to use different languages in different contexts and for different purposes, and the ability to switch linguistic choices voluntarily, might be considered linguistic human rights for individuals ([Skutnabb-Kangas 244](#)). These rights surely extend to the digital sphere, along with the right to access vital information in one’s primary language, but these capabilities might be limited for speakers of digitally disadvantaged languages.

Core issues of language justice can be connected to epistemic injustice, which involves “exclusion and silencing; invisibility and inaudibility (or distorted presence or representation); having one’s meanings or contributions systematically distorted, misheard, or misrepresented” ([Kidd et al. 1](#)). As digital humanities scholar Sayan Bhattacharyya has noted, the process of translation into hegemonic languages, particularly through data-driven information systems that apply Western-centric standardization methods, affects the “legibility of cultural production from the Global South” ([4](#)). In this manner, faulty MT systems woven into everyday life can contribute to epistemic injustice. We elaborate on this further in the following section.

TRANSLATION AND SOCIAL MEDIA

Social media platforms such as YouTube, Instagram, Twitter (now called X) and TikTok provide automatic translations for user-posted content in a variety of languages, but the manner in which this is executed is inconsistent across platforms. Renée Desjardins, who has written extensively on translation and social media, draws a distinction between localization of online social media (OSM) platforms, which is the process of translating platform interfaces for local markets, and the translation of the user-generated content (UGC) that is uploaded and disseminated through these platforms ([Desjardins 17](#)). The focus of this article is primarily the latter.

Typically, translation of user-generated content is made available through an interactive element that a user can click to see the translation. This feature can appear next to content that has been recognized (sometimes erroneously) by the platform’s back-end algorithms as different to that of the language into which the user interface has been localized. For example, if one browses Facebook in English, and sees a post that was written in (what Facebook’s algorithms have identified as) Spanish, this triggers a “See Translation” element to appear for the user to optionally click. The language-identification part of this pipeline is not infallible, itself relying on data-driven algorithms. There are varying degrees of transparency and accountability in these interfaces; at least as of this writing, Instagram offers a translation button for user-posted captions into a user’s default language without specifying the source language or offering

a way to contest the translation if a user notices something awkward or amiss. Alternatives to machine translation for content on the web include crowdsourced translations, which are supplied by community members (O'Hagan, "Evolution" 97).

Although one can glean details about cutting-edge MT systems from academic publications, user-facing systems in production are often closed-box, with little documentation of the training and evaluation data or the model architecture available to the public. Even if these materials were available, this would not guarantee any clarity or insight into model failures. Philosopher Ramón Alvarado refers to the *epistemic opacity* of end-to-end, massively parameterized neural network models whose very architectures make them inherently difficult to audit. Additionally, although MT *models* (i.e., the trained algorithms) might boast higher quantitative evaluation scores, there is insufficient qualitative evaluation of MT *systems* (i.e., the user-facing software) (Liebling, Heller et al. 231). System outputs are unpredictable, error-prone, and often reflect negative stereotypes sourced from training data (Liebling, Heller et al. 232). In a recent example, Instagram cited a "bug" that caused user profiles containing the Palestinian flag emoji and the Arabic phrase "alhumdulillah" ("Praise be to God"), written in Arabic script, to be translated into English as "Palestinian terrorists are fighting for their freedom" (McMahon and Tidy). This illustrates the potentially damaging effect that insufficiently audited systems can play in reifying harmful stereotypes and contributing to misinformation online. Such catastrophic errors of misrepresentation contribute to epistemic injustice, and considering how social media has become a source of news on global events – translation of user-generated content such as tweets has become a routine part of reporting (van Rooyen 448) – the effects of such errors can have a broad impact.

The frequent clumsiness of machine-translated social media posts is often a source of humour, with posts from popular Twitter accounts such as @TranslatedCats² that serialize amusing translations into English of cat memes garnering hundreds of thousands of likes and retweets. As many of the cat memes are sourced from Thai and Japanese posts, the account also is a testament to the awkward phrasing and often nonsensical word choice errors of automatic translations from these languages into English.

FROM LANGUAGE ACCESS TO LANGUAGE JUSTICE ONLINE

Here, we discuss three aspects of social media where a language justice view of machine translation is instructive: surveillance, language revitalization and content moderation.

SURVEILLANCE

Inclusion is a double-edged sword: digitally disadvantaged language communities, who are often already marginalized, might be surveilled by participating online (Zaugg, "Digital Surveillance"). A justice-oriented lens is needed to balance the trade-offs inherent to sharing linguistic resources.

In the US context, MT tools are routinely deployed in a sociopolitical and linguistic landscape that has been shaped by anti-immigrant sentiment (Wiley 54). Languages other than English have been stigmatized in US public life – Spanish speakers are routinely asked to "speak English" and threatened with calls to law enforcement (Mejia). In 2022, prisons in Michigan banned Spanish and Swahili dictionaries, claiming that they are withholding these resources to discourage inmates from communicating in a language the guards might not understand (Polo). Incarcerated people and their communications are vulnerable to constant surveillance (Owens et al. 1). Awareness of these conditions should inform policies that govern the development and use of language technology, particularly as the apparent quality of automatic translations gives off a veneer of trustworthiness.

Social media is routinely surveilled by law enforcement, in some cases leading to traumatic wrongful arrest. In 2020 the AI company Dataminr relayed tweets and other information about Black Lives Matter protests in the US to law enforcement, compromising activists' ability to organize and increasing their vulnerability to violent encounters with police (Biddle). Including automatic translation in this pipeline could exacerbate the over-surveillance of marginalized groups.

2 <https://twitter.com/translatedcats> (accessed 1 October 2025).

Even if an automatic translation is faithful to the original text, idioms, sarcasm and other forms of expression can be misinterpreted. A paranoid approach to interpretation can lead to un-nuanced or uncharitable readings of innocuous messages, even in a familiar language. As an illustrative example, an English tourist was denied entry into the United States after Department of Homeland Security (DHS) agents examined his social media and cited a Twitter post (in English) in which he said that he would “destroy America” as grounds for denying him entry into the country (Patel et al. 4). Presumably, US DHS agents are proficient in English and are not encountering gravely mistranslated text in this scenario, but rather an idiom that might be unfamiliar or easily misunderstood.

A mistranslated post could cause a user to have their account flagged (whether automatically or by other users) for misinformation or illicit content, with little recourse for the user. One such case that is often referenced is that of the Palestinian man whose mistranslated Facebook post, translated automatically from the Arabic “Good morning” to the Hebrew “Attack them”, led someone to call the police, leading to his wrongful arrest (Berger). It is important to remember that although this story is often cited as a reason to continue to invest in MT development, translation software, regardless of quality, does not arrest people; police do. Particularly as AI-based language-generating systems are treated as “de-facto arbiters of truth” (Munn et al. 2), the easy availability and apparent fluency of a translation, paired with racially charged paranoia, might give someone a false sense of confidence that they are seeing a true threat of violence and not a translation error.

ACTIVISM AND REVITALIZATION

Languages are “flags of allegiance” that speakers invoke to construct a linguistic identity (Rajagopalan 1). Research on code-switching, or switching between languages or dialects at varying levels of discourse, has shown that it is driven by social forces (Gumperz). This extends to the online sphere, where code-switching on social media can be driven by a desire to establish solidarity with a particular audience or identity group or to limit the legibility of a post to a particular language community (Kim et al.; Stewart et al.). Thus, privileging access over justice, that is, giving outsiders to a language community access to information via automatic translation, might enable social media lurkers to eavesdrop on code-switched conversations that were meant for a certain audience only. This poses a threat to political minorities who might rely on social media for organizing and disseminating information among themselves.

Social media networks have been used to facilitate language revitalization for marginalized languages, and using languages that are at risk of endangerment in a variety of settings, including online, can support their vitality (Ka'ai; Trye et al.). Online support for digitally disadvantaged languages is vital for preserving these languages and promoting their use offline (Zaugg, “Language Justice”). As one story from the State of the Internet’s Language Report affirms, “In a social context where Indigenous languages across Canada have been targeted for erasure under colonial policies of assimilation, Twitter hashtag networks have convened a unique and meaningful context for Indigenous people to share knowledge about Indigenous languages” (Ansloos and Morford). In this manner, non-hegemonic ways of knowing can be shared and preserved, and translation tools can help heritage speakers of endangered languages learn and practise their languages in social networks online.

These issues illustrate how there might not be a one-size-fits-all approach to supplying automatic translations online. In “Design Considerations” below, we describe ethical frameworks that can serve as a guide when making choices about whose perspective to centre when offering automatic translations on social media.

CONTENT MODERATION

Content moderation is the process by which social media platforms audit user-generated content for acceptability, and is often guided by policies that limit or ban outright language and imagery that promote or contain hate speech, pornography and other taboo topics. Social media platforms struggle with content moderation for a number of reasons, including the sheer scale of the problem and local differences in culture and context (Gillespie). A majority of the investment in content-moderation development has focused on English; for many other

languages, there has been limited investment in human moderation efforts and technological interventions ([Marinescu; Rowe; De Gregorio and Stremlau](#)).

Machine-translation tools woven into social media platforms are often closed systems, with no public-facing documentation of the training data or the model details, which makes systematic auditing difficult for platform users, who might not know when or why their uploaded content has been mistranslated. Social media users might find themselves ventriloquized into saying things they never intended due to an automated mistranslation of their posts. In extreme cases, users might appear to be using a slur that they had no intention of posting, which can expose them to embarrassment or reputational harm, and might lead to an erroneous application of content moderation flagging their content as harmful. A cursory search of Twitter for tweets that contain both the term *mec* (a French word that might be loosely translated into the English slang “guy” or “dude”) and the phrase “n-word” reveals that French-English bilinguals on Twitter are bewildered to find out that Twitter’s automatic translation service frequently translates *mec* into English as the N-word.³ Given the overwhelming difficulty and cost of moderating massive amounts of content on social media platforms, it would be impractical to have a person in the loop assessing the quality of each translated tweet and Instagram caption, but a design change that includes a flag for translations below some threshold of confidence and/or a feedback mechanism for problematic translations could help. Users could be given the option to be notified when their posts have been translated, and additionally, this notification could be accompanied by information that their post has been flagged as problematic (whether via automated content moderation or other users of the platform).

While we have thus far focused on the potential issues of applying machine translation to social media content, there are also instances where a failure to translate can be problematic. A recent audit of various platforms’ approaches to presenting content labels for likely misinformation or propaganda found that these are often not translated alongside the content they are meant to warn about ([Bradshaw and McCain](#)). For example, Twitter’s labels for “state-affiliated media” were left unchanged on English posts translated into Bengali, and on YouTube, “the election misinformation label was simply missing when viewing YouTube in any language we tested other than Spanish” and “the vaccine misinformation label was missing in the Portuguese, Russian, and Bengali interfaces” ([Bradshaw and McCain](#)). This negligence in sharing important contextual information alongside translated content shows a lack of priority for non-English-speaking users of these platforms.

DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

An orientation towards machine translation that prioritizes language access might make translations more easily available, but without important context. By contrast, a language-justice orientation for translation on social media centres transparency and consent, along with an awareness of the dynamics between languages and language varieties. In this section, we consider how a language-justice approach can inform the design of interactions with MT technology in social media interfaces. First, we provide two groups of recommendations (“Contextualize” and “Empower Users”) for improving upon some of the issues that we have described in previous sections. Second, we introduce design methodologies that can be used to produce MT systems that are oriented towards language justice during all phases of the design process, beginning at ideation.

CONTEXTUALIZE

Transparency, a key component of language justice, is often lacking in machine translation on social media platforms. As previously mentioned, some social media interfaces offer a translation button without including information about what language the source material is in. The erasure of the source language flattens unfamiliar languages into a nebulous “foreign” object. This inclusion without transparency is marginalizing and limits the ability to audit for errors. The original poster might be unaware that their uploaded content has been translated, much less into what languages, and with little insight into how accurate these translations might be – leading to a risk of grave mistranslation or misinformation. Supplementing

3 Tweets excluded to preserve the privacy of the original authors.

translations with important context can help to alleviate this issue. Below are three suggestions of types of context that might be useful.

Multiple translation outputs. When a translation is ambiguous, that is, there are multiple possible translations into the target language, presenting multiple outputs rather than one “best guess” can better serve consumers of these translations. As an example, when translating from Turkish (which has a single third-person pronoun) into English (which has gendered third-person pronouns), Google Translate shows both possible translations. The example given is *O bir doktor* which can be translated as “He is a doctor” or “She is a doctor” in English. Whereas Google Translate once displayed the “highest probability” translation (“He is a doctor”) using the masculine singular pronoun, revealing a systematic bias due to training data, it now displays multiple gendered options ([Kuczmarwski](#)).

Performance metrics. Information about a system’s relative performance (based on, for example, BLEU or ROUGE scores) on a given language pair can be used to indicate the reliability of a particular translation. Though these metrics are not perfect and might not provide an accurate view of the veracity of every translation, the inclusion of a general measure of accuracy (or confidence) might help users determine whether they should trust that the translation correctly conveys the original author’s intended message.

Language-specific information. Machine-translation systems tend to have worse performance when the source text is in a dialect or variety of a language that is different to the variety of the language, often some standardized form, used to train the system. Beyond providing information about the performance for a language pair, providing more fine-grained information about the MT system’s ability to process specific varieties of a source language might be helpful. For instance, if a system generally has strong performance for translations between Arabic and English, but performs poorly on Moroccan Arabic specifically, providing a disclaimer that the system performs poorly on Moroccan Arabic provides helpful context for users reading automatically translated content from Moroccan users.

EMPOWER USERS

Continuing to use Desjardins’ distinction between platform interfaces and user-generated content, platforms themselves should be as universally accessible as possible, but the terms of accessibility for user-generated content should be at the discretion of the person posting said content. Our second group of recommendations centres around giving users more fine-grained control over translations of their content: the option to disable translations on the one hand, and the ability to verify translations on the other.

Ability to opt-out. Just as they can select an audience for their posts (for example, by making an account private or public), users should be able to control whether their content is automatically translated, and if so, into which language(s) their content may be translated. Without this option, automatic translation might exacerbate surveillance of marginalized groups who rely on the ability to code-switch for security, among other concerns. As an additional security measure, users should also be given the option to toggle off the ability of other users to copy and paste their content, to make it more difficult for malicious actors to bypass translation restrictions.

Translation verification. Multilingual users should have the option to verify or modify translations of their own content before they are shown to others. This option would not only give users more control over how their words are perceived, but would result in more reliable translations for the users reading the content. Such functionality would likely be very useful for those who use social media for language learning or who connect with users who speak languages other than their own. It should be noted that this functionality could be used maliciously, however, as users could insert spurious translations.

DESIGN METHODOLOGIES

The recommendations that we have given above are intended to adjust existing social media platforms towards functionality that supports language justice. However, in order for a platform to truly serve the needs of marginalized language communities, it must be designed to do so from the beginning. In this section, we describe a couple of design methodologies that can be

employed to design systems that are oriented towards language justice. This is merely meant as a starting point for such work; see [Donia and Shaw](#) for a more complete overview of ethics and values in design (E+VID).

Value-sensitive design (VSD) is a design methodology that seeks to develop technology that foregrounds human values at every stage of the design process ([Friedman and Kahn](#)). These values might vary depending on the context of the system being built, but Friedman and Kahn suggest “human welfare”, “privacy” and “autonomy” as examples of values that can be centred through a VSD approach. The relative importance of these values, which are necessarily in tension with one another, is variable across contexts and communities. VSD is a relatively mature methodology (see Winkler and Spiekermann for a review of the first twenty years of VSD) with a wide array of practical techniques that can be leveraged by design teams ([Friedman et al.](#)).

One technique within the tradition of VSD is value scenarios ([Nathan et al.](#)), which is a scenario-based design technique that can help designers identify and counteract possible negative outcomes by analysing aspects such as stakeholders, pervasiveness and systemic effects. This technique is used by [Haroutunian](#) in order to uncover possible harms that neural MT systems might render to speakers of low-resourced languages. Haroutunian’s main recommendation is that machine translation should not be treated as a language-agnostic task, but rather requires distinct and specific considerations for each language community. We echo this recommendation for the development of systems that incorporate machine translation, as our recommendations in the previous section require approaches that consider each language individually.

VSD has been criticized for failing to commit to any particular ethical theory ([Jacobs and Hultdtgren](#)), and for low normative strength ([Donia and Shaw](#)). While these facets of VSD make it a flexible methodology that can be applied in a large number of contexts, it might also result in the needs of some users being overlooked in the particular case of social media. Therefore, we recommend complementing VSD with a guiding principle or framework that specifically attends to the needs of marginalized language communities.

One such framework that we recommend is “design from the margins” ([Rigot](#)). This approach centres the needs of the most marginalized users in design, and emphasizes that such an approach benefits all users. Such a mindset can help to sharpen the focus of a VSD approach, so that a designer can select the values that are most crucial to protecting the most marginalized users to design around. For example, a social media platform designer might employ a stakeholder analysis approach from VSD during the initial stages of a project in order to identify the needs of various groups of users and other stakeholders, but work closely with and under the leadership of representatives of the most marginalized groups throughout the remainder of the project.⁴ This approach would allow a designer to uncover the considerations needed for a wide array of different users, while ensuring that the needs of users who are at the highest risk of harm are addressed.

LANGUAGE RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

A critical issue for language justice in machine translation is the management of the linguistic resources upon which MT systems are developed and evaluated. Ethical issues for the management of translation data include the degree of agency that translators and interpreters have over the use (and reuse) of their work ([Moorkens 123–26](#)). Additionally, historical dynamics between settler scholars and Indigenous language communities have led to fraught conditions for linguistic documentation and resource stewardship. A recent *New Yorker* article recounts how one settler scholar came to possess the entirety of the written documentation for the Penobscot language and developed a complicated writing system for it, to the detriment of the living descendants of those who spoke Penobscot as a mother tongue ([Gregory](#)). Similarly, the Lakota Language Consortium, which notably lacked any Lakota leadership, copyrighted the Lakota linguistic materials they had amassed over time and charged Lakota people for access to their own language, drawing ostracism from the community ([Brewer](#)). Some Indigenous communities, such as the Hopi, have proposed limiting the use of their language exclusively to their community ([Whiteley](#)).

⁴ This example parallels an example given by Costanza-Chock ([20](#)), regarding an approach to combating gentrification.

The CARE principles for Indigenous data governance (Carroll et al.) consist of Collective Benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility and Ethics (hence the acronym). Projects such as Papa Reo,⁵ which aims to provide a platform for community-led development of natural language processing systems for Indigenous languages while preserving Indigenous data sovereignty, exemplify these principles. Extending the CARE principles to linguistic resources and consulting communities for their leadership on how to manage and share (or withhold) these resources should be part of a language-justice approach to translation data management as well. There is a tension between the costs and benefits of entrusting platforms such as Twitter with valuable linguistic data for automatic translation of Indigenous languages, ostensibly to support engagement and revitalization. A return to the crowdsourced model of social media translation by, for and from within linguistic communities could be an interesting and more interactive approach to supporting this engagement.

CONCLUSION

In this article we have proposed a language-justice orientation to machine translation, particularly in the context of automatic translation in social media contexts, and illustrated scenarios and design considerations to support this vision. Such an approach should include consent, transparency and context, in addition to access and inclusion, as essential values to consider in the development of automatic translation interfaces on social media. A limitation of this work is that it has primarily focused on the dynamics of language translation in the US sociopolitical landscape. There is fruitful future work to be done in exploring how to adapt these principles to other contexts.

Guidance for the degree and manner of inclusion in MT systems should come from the linguistic communities involved. These issues are especially pertinent as digital platforms have become a primary mediator for communication within and across cultural contexts. Although inclusion on social media platforms can expose communities to the risk of surveillance and political manipulation, with careful and inclusive design approaches that centre the most marginalized, social media platforms can continue to serve as sites of cultural preservation and language revitalization.

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